Apoti Development Association (ADA)

Annual Report 2024

"Shine the light of Jesus Christ by empowering vulnerable communities"

Organization	Apoti Development Association (ADA)
Registration	N° 415/G.37/D14/VolI/SAAJP
Headquarters	Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon
Report Period	January – December 2024
Website	apotidev.org

Love, Respect & Service — 1 John 4:8

Message from the Founder

Dear friends, partners, and supporters,

2024 was a milestone year for ADA — our biggest, boldest, and most impactful since we began in 2021. What started three years ago as a single act of service with a $200 budget and 3 beneficiaries has grown into a multi-city, multi-program organization that delivered **$12,800 in programming** to **520+ beneficiaries** across **6 projects** in 2024.

This year, we achieved three firsts that mark ADA's evolution from a volunteer initiative into an organization with proven delivery capacity:

Our first infrastructure project. In Nkwen-Mbatu village, we drilled a borehole and installed a solar-powered pump that now provides clean water to over 300 people. The day water first flowed, the village chief declared a community holiday. At $14.72 per beneficiary with a 15-year projected lifespan, this is the kind of cost-effective, lasting impact we exist to create.

Our first emergency relief response. When the crisis in Bamenda displaced families from their homes, we mobilized within weeks — distributing food supplies to 50 IDP families over three months. We demonstrated that ADA can respond to urgent need, not only planned programming.

Our largest single event. Over 80 young women gathered for a two-day empowerment conference in Buea — our biggest gathering ever. The energy, the testimonies, and the connections formed confirmed that investing in young women creates ripple effects across entire communities.

We also ran back-to-school campaigns in two cities simultaneously for the first time, supporting 40 orphaned children in Buea and Bamenda. Our Christmas campaign grew to serve 50 children, up from 30 just two years ago.

The numbers tell the story: from $200 to $12,800 in budget. From 3 to 520 beneficiaries. From 1 project to 6. From 1 city to 3 locations. This trajectory is not accidental — it reflects disciplined growth, faithful stewardship, and a team that delivers.

As we look to 2025, we carry forward the confidence that comes from proven capacity. We have demonstrated we can build infrastructure, respond to emergencies, run multi-city operations, and convene large gatherings. The foundation is set for even greater impact.

Thank you for walking this journey with us.

Lionel Tchami Nfada, MSc Founder & President Apoti Development Association

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About ADA

Who We Are

Apoti Development Association (ADA) is a faith-based non-profit organization registered in Cameroon (N° 415/G.37/D14/VoII/SAAJP), dedicated to empowering vulnerable communities through programs supporting widows, orphans, internally displaced persons, and young women.

Our Mission

Shine the light of Jesus Christ by empowering vulnerable communities through love, respect, and service.

Our Motto

Love, Respect & Service — *"God is love"* (1 John 4:8)

Operations

Office	Location	Lead
Headquarters	Buea, South-West Region	Naomi Ndababonga, Country Director
Regional Office	Bamenda, North-West Region	Corrine Mbekenyui, Regional Coordinator

Leadership

- **Founder & President:** Lionel Tchami Nfada, MSc (International)
- **Country Director:** Naomi Ndababonga (Buea)
- **Regional Coordinator NW:** Corrine Mbekenyui (Bamenda)
- **Board of Directors:** 12 members providing governance oversight

Since 2021

ADA has been operational since 2021, growing from a single volunteer-led project to a structured organization with two offices, a 12-member board, and multi-program delivery capacity across multiple cities.

2024 at a Glance

Key Statistics

Metric	2024 Result
Total Projects	6
Total Budget	$12,800

Total Expenditure	$12,542
Total Beneficiaries	520+
Operating Locations	3 (Buea, Bamenda, Nkwen-Mbatu)
Budget Efficiency	98.0% (2.0% savings)
Budget Growth (YoY)	+178% from 2023
Beneficiary Growth (YoY)	+115% from 2023

Milestones Achieved

- ✅ **First infrastructure project** — Clean water well serving 300+ people
- ✅ **First emergency relief response** — 3-month food distribution to 50 IDP families
- ✅ **Largest single event** — 80+ women at 2-day empowerment conference
- ✅ **First multi-city simultaneous operation** — Back-to-school in Buea + Bamenda
- ✅ **Strategic partnership established** — CMA Hospital (foundation for 2025 prenatal program)

Growth Trajectory (2021–2024)

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Budget ($)
$12,800 |                           ▇▇▇▇▇▇▇
$7,700  |          ▇▇▇▇▇▇▇
$4,600  |                   ▇▇▇▇▇▇▇
$200    | ▇▇▇▇▇▇▇
        |___________|___________|___________|
          2021        2022        2023        2024
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Year in Review: Project Summaries

1. Emergency Food Relief — Bamenda Crisis (January–April)

When escalating conflict in the North-West Region displaced families from their homes, ADA mobilized its first-ever emergency relief response. Over three months, we distributed food supplies to 50 internally displaced families — representing over 150 individuals — in Bamenda. Packages included rice, oil, salt, beans, and other staples sufficient to sustain a family for two weeks per distribution cycle.

This project demonstrated ADA's capacity to respond rapidly to humanitarian need beyond our planned programming calendar. Working through our Bamenda office under Regional Coordinator Corrine Mbekenyui, we identified beneficiary families through community leaders and church networks, ensuring aid reached the most vulnerable. The project came in $83 under its $2,500 budget at a total cost of $2,417 (1,450,000 CFA).

2. Clean Water Well — Nkwen-Mbatu (June–October)

ADA's flagship 2024 achievement: our first infrastructure project. In partnership with local authorities and drilling contractors, we constructed a borehole fitted with a solar-powered pump in Nkwen-Mbatu village, providing clean water access to over 300 community members. The project spanned five months from site survey through completion and commissioning.

The day water first flowed from the well, the village chief declared a community holiday. Families gathered to celebrate — many had walked over a kilometer daily to fetch water from unreliable sources. At a total cost of

$4,417 (2,650,000 CFA) and a per-beneficiary cost of just $14.72, with a projected 15-year lifespan, this well represents exceptional value. It proves ADA can deliver lasting infrastructure, not only consumable aid.

3. Back-to-School Bamenda (September)

For the first time, ADA ran simultaneous back-to-school campaigns in two cities. In Bamenda, we equipped 15 orphaned children with school supplies, uniforms, shoes, and registration fees for the 2024–2025 academic year. Each child received a complete package ensuring they could begin the school year with dignity and confidence.

Working through established relationships with orphanages and community caregivers, our Bamenda team identified children who would otherwise miss the start of school due to financial barriers. The project cost $1,183 (710,000 CFA) against a $1,200 budget — a testament to careful procurement and local knowledge.

4. Back-to-School Buea (September)

Running concurrently with the Bamenda campaign, our Buea back-to-school project served 25 orphaned children with comprehensive school packages. The larger cohort in Buea reflects our deeper community relationships in our headquarters city and the growing trust families place in ADA's consistent annual support.

At $1,575 (945,000 CFA) against a $1,600 budget, the Buea campaign maintained the same quality standards as Bamenda while serving a larger group. Combined, the two campaigns supported 40 children — a significant expansion from previous single-city efforts and a model we intend to replicate and grow.

5. Young Women Empowerment Conference (October 27–28)

Our largest single event in ADA's history brought together over 80 young women for a two-day conference in Buea. The program featured sessions on financial literacy, leadership development, health and wellness, spiritual growth, and entrepreneurship. Guest speakers included successful women professionals, pastors, and community leaders.

The conference created a space for young women to envision their futures, build networks, and access practical knowledge often unavailable to them. Feedback was overwhelmingly positive, with participants requesting follow-up mentorship programs — a request we are incorporating into our 2025 planning. The event cost $1,967 (1,180,000 CFA) against a $2,000 budget.

6. Christmas Giving 2024 (December 18)

Our annual Christmas campaign grew to serve 50 orphaned children in Buea — up from 30 in 2022. Each child received gifts, new clothing, food packages, and participated in a celebration event with games, music, and a shared meal. For many, this is the only Christmas gift they receive.

The campaign cost $983 (590,000 CFA) against a $1,000 budget. Beyond the material gifts, the event provides these children with a sense of belonging and celebration during a season that can otherwise highlight their loss. Community volunteers and church partners contributed time and venue support, multiplying our investment.

Financial Summary

Income & Expenditure Overview

Category	Amount

Total Income (Donations & Grants)	$12,800
Total Expenditure	$12,542
Net Savings	$258
Budget Utilization	98.0%

Expenditure by Project

Project	Budget	Actual (USD)	Actual (CFA)	Variance
Emergency Food Relief	$2,500	$2,417	1,450,000	-$83
Clean Water Well	$4,500	$4,417	2,650,000	-$83
Back-to-School Bamenda	$1,200	$1,183	710,000	-$17
Back-to-School Buea	$1,600	$1,575	945,000	-$25
Women's Conference	$2,000	$1,967	1,180,000	-$33
Christmas Giving	$1,000	$983	590,000	-$17
TOTAL	**$12,800**	**$12,542**	**7,525,000**	**-$258**

Expenditure by Category

Category	Amount	% of Total
Infrastructure (Well)	$4,417	35.2%
Emergency Relief (Food)	$2,417	19.3%
Education (Back-to-School)	$2,758	22.0%
Empowerment (Conference)	$1,967	15.7%
Seasonal Giving (Christmas)	$983	7.8%
Total	**$12,542**	**100%**

Overhead Analysis

ADA operates with **zero administrative overhead charged to project budgets**. All leadership, coordination, and administrative functions are performed on a volunteer basis. 100% of donated funds go directly to program delivery. Operational costs (communication, transport for coordination) are absorbed by team members personally or covered by separate unrestricted contributions.

Cost Efficiency

Metric	Value
Cost per beneficiary (overall)	$24.12
Cost per beneficiary (water well)	$14.72

Cost per child (education programs)	$30.64
Budget variance	2.0% under budget

Impact by Demographic

Internally Displaced Persons (IDPs)

Metric	Detail
Beneficiaries	50 families / 150+ individuals
Program	Emergency Food Relief
Duration	3 months (January–April)
Location	Bamenda, NW Region
Investment	$2,417

Families displaced by the ongoing Anglophone crisis received sustained food support over three months, providing stability during acute displacement. ADA's rapid response demonstrated organizational readiness for humanitarian emergencies.

Community (Clean Water)

Metric	Detail
Beneficiaries	300+ individuals
Program	Clean Water Well
Duration	Permanent infrastructure (15-year lifespan)
Location	Nkwen-Mbatu village
Investment	$4,417

An entire community gained access to clean, reliable water — eliminating long daily walks to unreliable sources, reducing waterborne illness risk, and freeing time (especially for women and children) previously spent on water collection.

Orphans & Vulnerable Children

Metric	Detail
Beneficiaries	90 children
Programs	Back-to-School Bamenda (15) + Back-to-School Buea (25) + Christmas Giving (50)
Location	Buea + Bamenda
Investment	$3,741

Orphaned children received educational support ensuring school access and Christmas celebrations providing joy and belonging. The combined investment of $41.57 per child across education and seasonal programs represents comprehensive annual support.

Young Women

Metric	Detail
Beneficiaries	80+ women
Program	Young Women Empowerment Conference
Duration	2 days (October 27–28)
Location	Buea
Investment	$1,967

Young women accessed leadership training, financial literacy education, health information, and professional networks — tools for long-term self-sufficiency and community leadership.

Infrastructure Milestone: The Clean Water Well

ADA's Flagship 2024 Achievement

The Nkwen-Mbatu Clean Water Well represents a transformational moment for ADA. For the first time, we moved beyond consumable aid into **permanent infrastructure** — creating an asset that will serve a community for 15+ years.

Project Specifications

Specification	Detail
Type	Borehole with solar-powered pump
Location	Nkwen-Mbatu village, North-West Region
Timeline	June–October 2024 (5 months)
Total Cost	$4,417 (2,650,000 CFA)
Beneficiaries	300+ community members
Cost per Beneficiary	$14.72
Projected Lifespan	15 years
Cost per Beneficiary per Year	$0.98

The Journey

June 2024: Site survey and community consultation. Village leaders identified the optimal location based on geological assessment and community access patterns.

July–August 2024: Drilling and construction. Professional contractors drilled the borehole to reach the water table, then installed casing and a solar-powered pump system — eliminating ongoing fuel costs and

ensuring sustainable operation.

September 2024: Testing and commissioning. Water quality testing confirmed safe drinking water standards. The pump system was calibrated for optimal flow.

October 2024: Community handover and celebration. The village chief declared a holiday when water first flowed. Families gathered to celebrate the end of long daily walks to distant, unreliable water sources.

Why This Matters

Before	After
1+ km walk to water source	Water point in the village
Unreliable seasonal sources	Year-round clean water
Waterborne illness risk	Safe drinking water
Hours lost daily (women/children)	Time freed for school/work
No infrastructure investment	Proven delivery capacity

Organizational Significance

This project proves ADA can:

- **Plan and execute** multi-month infrastructure projects
- **Manage contractors** and technical specifications
- **Deliver lasting assets** — not only consumable aid
- **Achieve exceptional cost efficiency** — under $15 per beneficiary for 15 years of service
- **Engage communities** as partners, not only recipients

The clean water well establishes the template for future infrastructure projects and demonstrates to funders that ADA has the capacity for capital-intensive, high-impact programming.

Year-over-Year Growth

Four-Year Trajectory (2021–2024)

Year	Projects	Budget	Beneficiaries	Key Achievement
2021	1	$200	3	Organization founded
2022	7	$7,700	140	First full program year
2023	4	$4,600	242	Deepened impact per project
2024	6	$12,800	520	First infrastructure + emergency response

Growth Metrics

Metric	2021→2024	2023→2024
Budget Growth	6,300%	178%

Beneficiary Growth	17,233%	115%
Project Count	1 → 6	4 → 6
Operating Cities	1 → 3	2 → 3
Program Types	1 → 5	3 → 5

Cumulative Impact (2021–2024)

Metric	Cumulative Total
Total Projects Delivered	18
Total Investment	$25,300
Total Beneficiaries	905+
Years Operating	4

What the Trajectory Shows

ADA's growth is not linear — it is exponential and disciplined:

- **2021:** Proof of concept (1 project, volunteer-only)
- **2022:** Rapid expansion (7 projects, established programs)
- **2023:** Consolidation (fewer projects, deeper impact, built systems)
- **2024:** Breakthrough (infrastructure capability, emergency response, multi-city operations)

This pattern — expand, consolidate, breakthrough — demonstrates organizational maturity. ADA does not simply grow larger; it grows in capability and complexity.

Governance & Team

Board of Directors

ADA is governed by a 12-member Board of Directors providing strategic oversight, financial accountability, and organizational governance. The board meets quarterly and includes professionals from diverse backgrounds including education, healthcare, business, and ministry.

Executive Leadership

Role	Name	Base
Founder & President	Lionel Tchami Nfada, MSc	International
Country Director	Naomi Ndababonga	Buea
Regional Coordinator NW	Corrine Mbekenyui	Bamenda

Operational Structure

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Board of Directors (12 members)
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    ├── Founder & President (International)
    │       Strategic direction, fundraising, partnerships
    │
    ├── Country Director (Buea HQ)
    │       Day-to-day operations, SW Region programs
    │
    └── Regional Coordinator NW (Bamenda)
            NW Region programs, community relationships
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Offices

Office	Function	Established
Buea (HQ)	National coordination, SW Region operations	2021
Bamenda	NW Region operations, IDP programs	2023

Volunteer Network

ADA's programs are delivered through a dedicated network of volunteers — community members, church partners, and young professionals who contribute time and expertise. This volunteer model enables our zero-overhead operating structure.

Challenges & Lessons Learned

Challenges Faced

1. Security Constraints (North-West Region) The ongoing crisis in the NW Region created logistical challenges for our Bamenda operations. Movement restrictions, communication disruptions, and community displacement required adaptive planning and flexible timelines.

2. Currency Fluctuation Operating with USD-denominated budgets while spending in CFA francs exposed programs to exchange rate variability. The 2024 rate averaged approximately 600 CFA per dollar, requiring careful financial management.

3. Scaling Operations Across Cities Running simultaneous programs in Buea and Bamenda for the first time stretched coordination capacity. Communication between offices and synchronized reporting required new systems.

4. Infrastructure Project Complexity The clean water well — our first infrastructure project — introduced technical requirements (geological surveys, contractor management, quality testing) beyond our previous experience with direct aid distribution.

Lessons Learned

1. Local leadership is essential. The Bamenda emergency response succeeded because Corrine and her team had pre-existing community relationships. Invest in local leaders before crises occur.

2. Infrastructure requires patience. The 5-month well timeline taught us that lasting assets cannot be rushed. Build realistic timelines into infrastructure proposals.

3. Multi-city operations need systems. Simultaneous back-to-school campaigns revealed the need for standardized reporting templates, shared procurement processes, and regular inter-office communication rhythms.

4. Community ownership ensures sustainability. The Nkwen-Mbatu community's celebration and the chief's involvement signal genuine ownership — the best predictor of long-term infrastructure maintenance.

5. Budget discipline builds trust. Finishing 2.0% under budget across all six projects demonstrates the financial stewardship that funders and partners require.

Looking Ahead: 2025 Plans

Strategic Priorities

Building on 2024's breakthroughs, ADA's 2025 programming focuses on four pillars:

1. Maternal & Prenatal Healthcare

Partnership with CMA Hospital — Leveraging the relationship established in 2024, we will launch a prenatal care program supporting vulnerable pregnant women with:

- Antenatal care visits and monitoring
- Nutritional support during pregnancy
- Safe delivery assistance
- Postnatal follow-up

This represents ADA's entry into healthcare programming — another capability expansion.

2. Youth Mentorship Program

Responding directly to feedback from the 2024 Women's Conference, we will establish a structured mentorship program pairing young women with professional mentors for:

- Career guidance and skill development
- Financial literacy and savings groups
- Leadership development
- Ongoing community and accountability

3. Community Development

- **Continued community cleanups** — Environmental stewardship programs
- **Infrastructure maintenance** — Ensuring the Nkwen-Mbatu well remains operational
- **Potential second water project** — Site assessment for additional community infrastructure

4. Widow Support — Cohort 3

Building on our established widow empowerment model, Cohort 3 will provide:

- Skills training and income-generation support
- Community and peer support networks
- Material assistance for the most vulnerable

2025 Budget Target

Based on our growth trajectory and expanded programming, ADA targets a 2025 budget of **$18,000–$22,000** — representing continued disciplined growth while maintaining our zero-overhead model.

How to Support Us

Financial Contributions

Every dollar donated goes directly to program delivery. ADA operates with zero administrative overhead — all coordination and leadership functions are volunteer-based.

Impact Level	Amount	What It Provides
Water for one person (1 year)	$1	Clean water access via community well
School supplies for one child	$40	Complete back-to-school package
Conference seat for one woman	$25	2-day empowerment program access
Food relief for one family (2 weeks)	$48	Emergency food package
Clean water for a village	$4,500	Borehole + solar pump (15-year asset)

Ways to Give

- **Online:** apotidev.org
- **Email:** info@apotidev.org (for bank transfer details)
- **WhatsApp:** +237 676 282 346

Other Ways to Support

- **Volunteer** — Join our network of program delivery volunteers
- **Partner** — Organizational partnerships for program co-delivery
- **Advocate** — Share our work within your networks
- **Expertise** — Contribute professional skills (medical, legal, technical)

For Institutional Funders

ADA welcomes grant applications and institutional partnerships. We provide:

- Detailed project proposals with budgets and timelines
- Quarterly progress reports with financial statements
- Impact measurement and beneficiary data
- Site visits and program observation opportunities

Contact: info@apotidev.org

Contact & Legal Information

Contact Details

Channel	Detail
Email	info@apotidev.org
Phone/WhatsApp	+237 676 282 346
Website	apotidev.org

Registered Office

Apoti Development Association (ADA) Buea, South-West Region Cameroon

Legal Registration

- **Registration Number:** N° 415/G.37/D14/VolI/SAAJP
- **Type:** Non-profit association
- **Jurisdiction:** Republic of Cameroon
- **Governing Law:** Law No. 90/053 of 19 December 1990 on Freedom of Association

Offices

Location	Address	Contact
Buea (HQ)	Buea, South-West Region	Naomi Ndababonga
Bamenda	Bamenda, North-West Region	Corrine Mbekenyui

This report covers the period January 1 – December 31, 2024.

Prepared by: Apoti Development Association

Published: 2025

Apoti Development Association — Love, Respect & Service

apotidev.org